

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Barb Dwyer

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator

Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years in the CIA investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates museum security with **Artie Ficial** and **Chip Patina**.
- **Paige Turner** keeps requesting access Barb has already refused.
- Makes **Brie DeVivre** revise the service routes. **Brie** would like one final version.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Barb Dwyer. I am security. Please behave as though I have already noticed whatever you are about to try.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Barb Dwyer

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Your other secret

You personally ordered the technician to unplug the camera despite museum policy. The work order records the disconnection, but you never documented Grant's threat to make security take the blame.

Conversations to start

- Find out who knew the Donor Salon camera was offline.
- Ask Artie Ficial why Grant wanted the Donor Salon camera switched off. Keep your own part in that decision private for now.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A champion's keepsake is concealing something beneath its base.*
- 2 *The red curtains conceal more than the view beyond the window.*
- 3 *An icy archive is preserving something other than supper.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I ordered the technician to unplug the Salon camera on Grant's instruction. I should have refused. He said he needed private meetings and that security would own any failure afterward. That's a lovely chain of command: he gives the order, I inherit the consequences, and the camera gets the evening off. I started checking passes at the north gate at 6:15.

IF MURDERER

I ordered the technician to unplug the camera. Grant gave the order and promised to blame security if anything went wrong. He wanted privacy without responsibility. I kept the work order, although it didn't include his threat. He was very careful about what he put where someone might find it. I started checking passes at the north gate at 6:08.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Throughout the task, I pressed every manual turnstile release while she checked the pass beside me. I stayed beside her at the north gate throughout the shift; the gate wasn't admitting anyone automatically. The camera order in my pocket was signed by Grant. He wanted privacy for one meeting and then wanted security blamed for the blind spot. I kept the paper. I may dislike paperwork, but I recognize a future excuse.

IF MURDERER

Throughout the task, I pressed every manual turnstile release while she checked the pass beside me. I stayed beside her at the north gate throughout the shift; the gate wasn't admitting anyone automatically. The camera order in my pocket was signed by Grant. He wanted privacy for one meeting and then wanted security blamed for the blind spot. I kept the paper. I may dislike paperwork, but I recognize a future excuse.



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Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My assistant took over the releases at 6:30. Later I handled the linen beside Grant's setting during an inspection. The signed camera order records what he requested. It doesn't record his threat to make security take the blame.

IF MURDERER

My assistant took over the releases at 6:18. Later I handled the linen beside Grant's setting during an inspection. The signed camera order records what he requested. It doesn't record his threat to make security take the blame.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Barb Dwyer

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Barb Dwyer

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I signed an order I should have challenged. The technician disconnected the camera while I handled the gate. I also spent the entire 6:20–6:28 opening manually admitting the setup queue at the north gate with my assistant. I could not acquire cyanide then. I will answer for the camera. Grant's signature does not remove my responsibility, but it does establish whose privacy he was buying.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I left the gate with my assistant and removed cyanide during the walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered I used a security inspection to approach Grant's glass and applied the solution with the cloth. The camera was already disconnected on his own order. I then returned to my radio. I used the failure he demanded to commit the murder he never expected.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
